INCH-POUND

MIL-C-44060D
5 March 1991
SUPERSEDING
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3 April 1989

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN A LA KING, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers thermostabilized chicken a la king in flexible packages for use as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat, Individual.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-44073 - Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flour, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service

(Copies are available from the Dairy Grading Section, Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2750, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 381)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Fresh Shelled Peas for Canning or Freezing
U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pimientos
U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms

(Copies are available from the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0709, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

U.S. Standards of Identity for Cream Cheese

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 650 California Street, Suite 800, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400-CD, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

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(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall be prepared from chilled or frozen ready-to-cook fowl (mature female chicken) which has been processed in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. All chicken (raw or cooked) shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Products Grading Certificate to certify class and condition of the product and either the initial chilling date or initial freezing (in-storage) date.

3.2.1.1 Chicken, chilled. Raw bone-in or boneless chicken received in the chilled state shall not have been previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 6 days following initial chilling and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.1.2 Chicken, frozen. Raw bone-in or boneless chicken received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F for a period of time not to exceed 120 days following initial freezing and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.1.3 Chicken, cooked, frozen. Frozen cooked chicken shall be prepared from chilled chicken that complies with 3.2.1 and 3.2.1.1. Chicken shall be processed in accordance with 3.3.1, and either 3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2. Cooked chicken, in either log or dice form, shall be packaged in USDA approved food packaging material and shall be frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or below within 72 hours. The packaged, frozen cooked chicken shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 60 days prior to pouch filling (see 3.4). The initial freezing (in-storage) date and processing and packaging requirements shall be certified by a USDA Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) Poultry Products Agent.

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* 3.2.1.3.1 Tempering/thawing. Tempering/thawing of frozen cooked chicken shall comply with the following:

a. Microwave tempering/thawing of frozen chicken is permitted provided excellent condition of the chicken, as determined by the USDA, is maintained.

b. The microwave tempering/thawing process shall not exceed 48 hours from time of removal of the chicken from the freezer to further preparation.

c. Regardless of the process used, frozen chicken shall be tempered/thawed to a temperature not to exceed 40°F.

d. When a tempering/thawing process other than microwave is used, the time from the start of the tempering/thawing process (removal from freezer) to further preparation shall not exceed 96 hours.

e. Chicken that has been tempered/thawed shall not be refrozen.

* 3.2.2 Broth, chicken. Chicken broth may be frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The broth shall be inspected in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. It shall be free from extraneous material and cracklings. If frozen, broth shall have been held at an internal temperature of 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to use in product formulation. The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free, and concentrated to a soluble solids level sufficient to comply with the solids requirement in the product formulation. The broth shall have a characteristic mild chicken broth odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by FDA. Once thawed, chicken broth shall not be refrozen.

3.2.3 Starch, food, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized modified maize food starch for use in canned foods and shall comply with MIL-STD-900. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The modified starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The cooked modified starch slurry prepared from the starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste.

* 3.2.4 Cheese, cream, dehydrated. The dehydrated cream cheese shall be derived from fresh cream cheese complying with the FDA Standards of Identity for Cream Cheese. The dehydrated cheese shall be white to light in color, be uniform in appearance and composition, and possess a characteristic pleasing and desirable flavor. The product shall be free from specks and burnt particles. The dehydrated cheese shall contain not more than 3.0 percent moisture and approximately 65 percent milkfat.

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3.2.4.1 Cheese, cream, fresh. Fresh cream cheese shall possess a delicate butter-like or creamy flavor and shall be moderately salted. The body and texture shall be smooth, creamy, and free from lumps and excess gumminess. The cream cheese shall be in excellent condition and free from discoloration or burnt particles. Fresh cream cheese shall comply with U.S. Standards of Identity for Cream Cheese. The fresh cream cheese shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 39° to 45°F for not more than 90 days from date of pack to product preparation (see 3.3.5).

* 3.2.5 Fat, chicken, rendered, frozen. Frozen rendered chicken fat shall have a clear, yellow color and a characteristic mild chicken-fat odor and flavor. The fat may contain USDA approved antioxidants. The chicken fat shall have a peroxide value not to exceed 6 meq./kg, a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.50 percent (expressed as oleic acid), and a moisture content not to exceed 0.25 percent. The chicken fat shall be produced in accordance with USDA regulations and shall have been held at an internal temperature of 0°F or lower for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to sauce formulation. Once thawed, chicken fat shall not be refrozen.

3.2.6 Mushrooms, canned, pieces and stems. The canned pieces and stems shall be U.S. Grade B or better, in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms. The mushrooms shall be drained prior to use in the sauce formulation. The canned mushrooms shall be from the latest season's pack.

3.2.6.1 Mushrooms, frozen, sliced. Frozen mushrooms shall be prepared from fresh, sound, properly trimmed and washed mushrooms possessing the characteristics of the species Agaricus (Psalliota) bisporus or Agaricus bitorquis. The mushrooms shall be of the white or cream color type and shall be of a randomly sliced style with approximately 1/8 inch slices. The frozen mushrooms shall be of the latest season's pack.

3.2.7 Peas.

* 3.2.7.1 Peas, green, fresh, shelled. The fresh shelled green peas shall be U.S. No. 2 or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Fresh Shelled Peas for Canning or Freezing. The peas shall be of such size as to not pass through a 9/32 inch sieve.

* 3.2.7.2 Peas, green, shelled, individually quick frozen (IQF). The IQF shelled green peas shall have been prepared from fresh green peas meeting the requirements of 3.2.7.1 and 3.3.3.1. The IQF shelled green peas shall be of the latest season's pack. Packaged IQF peas shall be free flowing from the package and shall not show evidence of thawing and re-freezing.

3.2.8 Shortening, powdered, vegetable (see 6.3). The powdered vegetable shortening shall consist of components which, when combined, will serve as a product whitening agent. The powdered shortening, when used as an ingredient

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in this product, shall withstand the conditions of thermoprocessing specified in this document without browning. A typical analysis of the powdered shortening follows:

Fat	20.00 percent ± 1.50 percent
Protein	4.75 percent ± 0.75 percent
Carbohydrates	70.00 percent ± 1.00 percent
Moisture	2.00 percent maximum

3.2.9 Pimiento, canned, chopped. Pimientos shall be of the chopped style and shall be U.S. Grade C or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pimientos.

3.2.10 Onion, dehydrated, chopped. Dehydrated chopped onions shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.11 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.12 Celery, dehydrated, sliced. The dehydrated celery slices shall be obtained from clean, sound Pascal type celery. The celery shall be approximately 3/8 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The slices shall be free flowing and have uniform bright color. The dehydrated celery shall have a moisture content not greater than 5.5 percent.

3.2.13 Pepper, green, sweet, dehydrated. The peppers shall be 1/4-inch dices of sweet bell peppers which have been air-dried, freeze-dried, or a combination of each. The pepper dices shall be practically free of seeds, seed cells, and diseased or rotted areas. The pepper dices shall possess a fresh, clean, typical sweet green pepper flavor and odor and a green, with minimal brownish, color. The moisture content shall be not greater than 5.0 percent.

3.2.14 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.15 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor, and a light color. The white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.16 Bay leaves, ground. Ground bay leaves shall be derived from the dried leaves of Laurus nobilis L. The bay leaves shall possess a pleasant, aromatic odor, a pungent, mildly bitter flavor, and a pale green to yellow

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green color. A minimum of 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve. Volatile oil content shall be not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground bay leaves.

3.2.17 Sodium tripolyphosphate. Sodium tripolyphosphate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.18 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.2.19 Water. Water used for ice-making, formulation, rehydration, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and further processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Chicken preparation. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless. The wing tips, giblets, neck, feet, and viscera shall be excluded. The boned meat shall be free of pin feathers, skin, blood clots, bruises, blemishes, ligaments, tendons, coarse connective tissue, cartilage, and bone greater than 0.3 inch in any dimension. The boneless chicken meat shall be comprised of at least 50 percent white meat. Cooked chicken dices shall be prepared in accordance with 3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2.

3.3.1.1 Preparation of individually quick frozen (IQF) chicken dices. The IQF chicken dices shall be prepared as follows:

a. The chicken shall be cooked either before or after deboning by any commercially acceptable cook method in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations.

b. The cooked chicken meat shall be cooled to an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F within 4 hours following the cooking process and shall be held not more than 48 hours at this temperature prior to dicing.

c. The cooked chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch dimensions. The diced meat shall be held not longer than 4 hours at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F from time of dicing to the beginning of the IQF process.

d. Immediately after the IQF process, the frozen chicken dices shall be screened to eliminate fines. The frozen and screened chicken dices shall be packaged and stored as specified in 3.2.1.3.

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* 3.3.1.2 Chicken log preparation and processing. The chicken logs shall be prepared and processed as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Chicken meat	95.75
Ice or ice water	3.00
Salt	1.00
Sodium tripolyphosphate	0.25

a. Fresh chilled chicken meat processed on the day of boning shall be coarse ground within 24 hours following boning. If fresh-chilled (not previously frozen) chicken meat is transported between plants, it shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F and coarse ground within 6 days following initial chilling. Frozen chicken meat shall be maintained at 0°F or lower until further processing and be coarse ground within 120 days after boning. The meat shall be mechanically coarse ground through a grinder plate having holes measuring 1 inch in diameter. The grinder shall be equipped with a 2-blade knife.

b. The coarse ground (chunked) chicken meat shall be mechanically mixed with the salt and sodium tripolyphosphate. The mixing shall continue until the mixture exhibits a sticky (tacky) consistency. The ground chicken meat shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F during this time period.

c. The mixed meat shall immediately be tightly stuffed into casings of a type and size to accommodate the cooking method and the finished product meat dimension requirement. Alternatively, the mixed meat may be formed in stainless steel molds to a size which will ensure compliance with finished product meat dimension requirements. The formed meat logs shall be in the cooking process within 4 hours after being formed. (This time period may be extended up to 24 hours, provided the meat logs are maintained at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F.)

d. The chicken logs shall be cooked in a cook house (smoke house without smoke) or by other commercially acceptable cook methods to provide a product meeting the finished product drained weight and other requirements. Water cooking is permitted only for the meat logs in casings provided they are cooked in water until the internal temperature of the log reaches 150° to 152°F.

e. Immediately after completion of the cooking process, the cooked chicken logs shall be placed in an ice water bath, or cooled by other commercially acceptable rapid cooling methods. During cooling, the internal temperature of the chicken log shall not remain between 130°F and 80°F for more than 1.5 hours nor between 80° to 40°F for more than 5 hours.

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3.7 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Poultry Products Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture. The dairy component shall originate from a dairy plant which is approved by the Dairy Grading Section, Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

* 4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer,

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and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch inspection. Inspection of filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

4.5.4 Net weight inspection. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty pouch. Any individual pouch having a net weight of less than 7.5 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 8.0 ounces.

4.5.5 Product and drained weight inspection.

4.5.5.1 Product inspection. The filled and sealed pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180° to 190°F water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in table I. The contents shall be inspected for the defects indicated in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	-	0	2
	20	40	1	2

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1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Presence of feathers or feather parts
102	Total weight of skin, bone, cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and discolored meat, collectively, is more than 0.20 ounce
103	Texture of chicken dices is dry, rubbery, or mushy
104	Texture of vegetables is mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough
105	Sauce consistency lumpy or is excessively thick or thin
106	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

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* 4.5.5.2 Drained weight inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180° to 190°F water for approximately 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table III. The drained weight shall be determined and inspected for the defects listed in table IV.

TABLE III. Double sampling plan for drained weight inspection 1/ 2/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	-	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

2/ To determine drained weight, the pouch contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch's volume of 180° to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated such as to liquify rendered fat and to remove the sauce without breaking the chicken dices or vegetables. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard No. 20 (0.0331 inch) sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the chicken dices or vegetables. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

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TABLE IV. Drained weight defects

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of chicken and vegetables (combined) in a pouch is less than 2.5 ounces 1/
102	Of the individual drained weight of product in a pouch, less than 2.0 ounces is whole intact chicken pieces 2/

1/ If the sample average drained weight of product is less than 3.0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

2/ For purpose of this examination, the definition of a whole chicken piece is one that measures not less than 1/4 inch in each of two separate dimensions.

4.5.6 Fat and salt content testing. Three filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot. The pouches shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Meat and Meat Products, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened pouches shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the pouches. The pouches shall be opened and the entire contents of each pouch shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat and salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the requirements of MIL-P-44073.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

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6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Shortening, powdered, vegetable. It has been found that powdered vegetable shortening Spray Dried Creaming Agent 4280 manufactured by Armour Food Ingredients, Springfield, Kentucky, meets the requirements of 3.2.8 and performs satisfactorily in this product.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Combat field feeding
Food processing
Operational rations
Pouch

6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0718)

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

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2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-C-44060D	1991 March 5

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

CHICKEN A LA KING, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	(1) Commercial 508-651-4501	(2) AUTOVON 256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: STRNC-WTP Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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